greatest danger to its grand project. The true message of Communism to an individual was unmistakable: the system treats you as a cog in the machinery of a society on its way to a perfect Communist world, so you treat other people like cogs too. And if I am not valued and appreciated as a distinct person but only considered as a replaceable cog, then why should I value my fellow citizens who share the same fate as cogs in a machine, and surely cannot be any better than me?[96] This emphasis on the mass society, 'the rise of the mass-man'[97] is something that connects Communism with Fascism. Everyday work routine (so often praised in the Anglo-Saxon/Protestant tradition as a virtue) was turned into a burden, a tiresome exercise which bore little relationship to one's social standing and could do little to affect it. Work, praised so highly in the Communist world, became of very little true value, an activity to be avoided, ineffective, and the products of it shabby and poor. On the other hand, what were glorified were the masses and the 'revolt of the masses',[98] the revolution. This is the reason why the Communist-led resistance to Nazis and Fascists during World War II has often been portrayed as a revolt, not as resistance. The emphasis was not on the resistance against the Nazis, but on the social revolution led in parallel, which in turn is retroactively legitimised through the resistance. It is therefore no coincidence that Svetlana Makarovič, a well-known writer and at the same time a leading figure of the contemporary leftist movement in Slovenia, continues to invoke the word 'revolt' in her activist engagement.[99]

This lack of self-confidence of the mass-man – of which a lack of personal responsibility is a corollary – has continued to impede the functioning of the state and society in many post-Communist countries, despite a changing culture and Generation Z's prevailing ignorance about the past. Personal responsibility was replaced by the actions of a man (or woman) as a part of the mass – the revolt.

This has had implications also in the economic sphere. The new political and economic system has unleashed the free spirit of enterprise, but this has certainly not been helped by the sad record of what has become known in Eastern Europe as 'wild privatisation', i.e. dubious, rigged privatisation, involving the use of insider information and a complete disregard for the position of the workers. In the often weak legal environment of the early transition period, this practice was usually possible because of the 'old-